

The Postcard in the Himalayan Willows in Leh plans to introduce winter snow-leopard safaris

objective therefore is not simply to replicate an urban luxury hotel in a wilderness setting but design a proposition that is appropriate to the destination," says Chadha.

Singh is concerned that the arrival of large hotel companies could encourage excessive development in fragile ecosystems.

CONSERVATION IN FOCUS

"Neither Ranthambhore nor JAWAI needs more hotels. We do not need more beds in our wildlife areas," argues Singh. Instead of simply adding rooms, Singh says operators should invest meaningfully in conservation, local employment, education, healthcare and habitat protection.

Chopra raises a related concern about wildlife destinations increasingly becoming wedding markets. "Luxury and conservation are not contradictory. Low-density, high-value tourism can actually be far more appropriate for a wildlife destination than high-volume development," he says.

Chadha similarly emphasises development that respects local ecology and communities. For ITC Hotels, sustainability, destination-specific design, and responsible operations are integral to the long-term commercial viability of the segment.

For Chopra, India already has the wildlife; what it needs is the hospitality and infrastructure to unlock its potential. As Rudyard Kipling once wrote, "Something hidden. Go and find it." BT